

Rajmohan Arumugam — School Education Portfolio

Detailed reference: what he has done, is doing now, and is going to do · Compiled August 2026

Note on sourcing: This document reproduces the full content and source citations from the underlying research. Anthropic/Claude has not independently re-verified the linked sources — confirm each claim before publication or official use. Proposals, announcements, and “future direction” items are explicitly flagged in the source material as not yet implemented or independently verified.

What Rajmohan Has Done

Rajmohan Arumugam became Tamil Nadu's School Education Minister in May 2026. His work so far has focused on foundational learning for younger children, government-school readiness, student welfare, regulation of private schools, technology-enabled education, enrolment and dropout prevention, and Tamil Nadu's established education-policy position. The official state department profile identifies him as Minister for School Education, Tamil Development, Information & Publicity, while the portfolio notification assigns him the School Education Department among his Cabinet responsibilities.

Source: tn.gov.in — department profile

One of his earliest school-education actions was the release of nine revised textbooks for Classes 1, 2, and 3 in May 2026. These were designed under a revised curriculum framework and were described as colourful, activity-rich learning materials. The purpose was to make early-grade learning more engaging and reduce dependence on memorisation alone. The new material was reported to support foundational learning, motor development, socio-emotional growth, values, life skills, and improved classroom participation.

Source: thehindu.com — new activity-rich textbooks

Rajmohan's role was to release these materials as the School Education Minister and communicate the government's approach to foundational education. The curriculum change was also linked with teacher training for teachers handling Classes 1–3, because new books alone cannot improve learning unless teachers are prepared to use activity-based teaching methods effectively.

Source: newindianexpress.com — Classes 1–3 textbooks

He was also involved in preparations for reopening schools after the summer break. Schools were required to make classrooms safe and clean, ensure drinking-water and toilet facilities were functioning, prepare kitchens for meal programmes, and check that smart boards and Hi-Tech labs were operational. These are department-level school-readiness measures, not solely his personal projects, but they were carried out during his tenure and reflect the administration's concern that schools should be ready before students return.

Source: news.careers360.com — school reopening and textbook rollout

The reopening date was moved to 4 June 2026 because of severe summer heat. On reopening-related events, Rajmohan reportedly inaugurated 21 smart boards in Chennai, distributed learning materials, and recognised students. This was a visible school-infrastructure and digital-learning activity, although the available report does not establish a state-wide smart-board rollout or quantify how many schools benefited beyond the reported inauguration.

Source: thenewsmill.com — smart boards at reopening

Rajmohan has also taken a strong public position on Tamil Nadu's language policy. He reaffirmed the two-language policy of Tamil and English and said the State would not shift to the three-language formula. He also argued that Tamil Nadu's existing education policy is adequate and publicly opposed the National Education Policy and NEET. This is a policy position and political commitment; it should not be represented as though he personally created the two-language policy or abolished NEET.

Source: thehindu.com — two-language policy

Source: education.economictimes.indiatimes.com — NEP and NEET position

Another important action was his public warning to private schools against collecting fees above the levels fixed by the official fee-determination committee. He said the state would act against institutions that demanded unauthorised fees. The policy purpose is to protect parents from excessive educational costs and ensure that private schools follow the statutory fee-regulation process.

Source: newindianexpress.com — private-school fee warning

Rajmohan also announced an online mechanism for private schools to apply for recognition-renewal orders and No-Objection Certificates. According to the announcement, the system was intended to begin on 1 July 2026 and was designed to reduce the role of middlemen, improve transparency, and curb opportunities for bribery in approval procedures. This is among the clearest process-reform announcements in his school-education tenure.

Source: newindianexpress.com — online NOC and recognition system

However, the public record currently verifies the announcement of the online system, not its full results. A website should therefore say that Rajmohan **announced** the online approvals process, not that he has already eliminated bribery, ended middlemen, or transformed all private-school approvals. There is no independently verified public data in the sources reviewed on applications processed, approval times, complaints reduced, or disciplinary cases resulting from the system.

Source: newindianexpress.com

Rajmohan also announced a stricter position on political and non-academic activity inside government schools. In July 2026, he said entry to school campuses would be regulated, and that political-party representatives, private organisations, and unauthorised visitors should not directly engage students. He also said that non-school events, including private celebrations, should not take place on school grounds without appropriate rules.

Source: newindianexpress.com — regulation of visitors to government schools

This position presents schools as spaces where students should be protected from unnecessary disruption and political influence. The stated priority is to preserve school safety, classroom discipline, institutional neutrality, and learning time. It is accurate to say he announced this direction; it is not yet possible to claim that a comprehensive state-wide visitor-regulation framework has been fully implemented without publication of the final rules or a government order.

Source: newindianexpress.com

In August 2026, Rajmohan said the government would withdraw cases registered against students who protested against NEET. He said this followed directions from Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay. The action is relevant to Rajmohan's education portfolio and his stated opposition to NEET, but the decision should be credited correctly: Rajmohan announced it, while the report attributes the direction to the Chief Minister.

Source: thehindu.com — withdrawal of cases against anti-NEET student protesters

He has also addressed school closure and dropout concerns. In an Assembly response reported in August 2026, Rajmohan said that schools closed for low enrolment could be reopened if at least 10 students enrolled. He said headteachers and teachers were undertaking door-to-door work to identify children who had stopped attending school, understand the reasons, and support their return to education.

Source: dynamalar.com — reopening low-enrolment schools

This is a meaningful commitment because a child leaving school may do so due to migration, poverty, family responsibilities, disability, poor transport, lack of awareness, or dissatisfaction with the school environment. Reopening local schools where enrolment returns and proactively identifying dropouts could reduce barriers to access. But the source does not supply a verified number of schools reopened or children re-enrolled. These should be treated as measures and commitments in progress, rather than achieved numerical outcomes.

Source: dynamalar.com

Rajmohan also responded to criticism of the School Education budget. In August 2026, he said the department's allocation of ■44,527 crore should be understood as a “real” increase because it was ■2,176 crore above the prior administration's reported actual expenditure of ■42,351 crore, rather than compared only with an earlier budget estimate.

Source: [dynamalar.com](#) — funding explanation

This is a ministerial explanation of the government's budget position, not an independently established proof that every educational service will improve. A website may say he defended the school-education allocation as an increase over previous actual expenditure, but should also recognise that budget comparisons are politically contested and depend on whether one compares budget estimates, revised estimates, or actual expenditure.

Source: [dynamalar.com](#)

What He Is Doing Now

Rajmohan's current school-education work appears to be centred on moving early announcements into administrative implementation. This includes overseeing the academic year after the revised Classes 1–3 textbook rollout, monitoring school readiness and learning infrastructure, addressing private-school regulation, and following up on enrolment and dropout issues.

Source: thehindu.com

Foundational learning

The revised early-grade books are now part of the school year, so the practical challenge is whether teachers receive adequate training, whether classrooms have needed materials, and whether the activity-based approach improves basic reading, writing, numeracy, and confidence among children. The sources establish the textbook release and planned teacher preparation, but no independently verified statewide learning-outcome results are yet available.

Source: thehindu.com

Private-school oversight

Rajmohan has publicly demanded compliance with approved fee levels and announced the online system for recognition and NOC-related approvals. If the administrative system is functioning as intended, it could reduce discretionary decision-making and make the process easier for legitimate applicants to track. But the present evidence does not yet show implementation performance, so this remains an area to monitor rather than a completed achievement.

Source: newindianexpress.com

Student retention and access

Rajmohan's Assembly statement on reopening schools with at least 10 students and identifying dropout children suggests an ongoing focus on bringing students back into the education system. This is especially important for small local schools and communities where distance to another school can become a barrier to attendance.

Source: dinamalar.com

Digitisation and emerging technology in government schools

The School Education Department has outlined an expansion path for TN SPARK, an emerging-technologies curriculum. Reporting says it was being piloted in roughly 5,000 schools, with plans to expand it to government schools for Classes 6–8, followed by coding material for higher classes.

Source: newindianexpress.com — TN SPARK and AI roadmap

This is an ongoing departmental plan rather than a completed full-state programme. Rajmohan can accurately be associated with the department's direction while he is minister, but the website should not claim he has already delivered AI or coding instruction to every student in every government school.

Source: newindianexpress.com

What He Is Going To Do

The most clearly reported future school-education initiative is the proposed expansion of **TN SPARK**. The department is expected to expand emerging-technology education for Classes 6–8 and progressively introduce coding and related curriculum for Classes 9–12. The stated goal is to give government-school students exposure to coding, AI-related concepts, and emerging technologies.

Source: newindianexpress.com

If the expansion proceeds, Rajmohan's ministerial responsibility will be to oversee the transition from a pilot programme to wider implementation. That would require curriculum design, teacher training, devices or lab access, reliable connectivity, learning materials, monitoring systems, and safeguards so that technology supports teaching rather than becoming a one-time publicity exercise. The source confirms the planned expansion, while these implementation requirements are the practical consequences of such a rollout.

Source: [newindianexpress.com](https://www.newindianexpress.com)

Another proposed future measure is the possibility of including **chicken biryani once a week** in government-school meals. Rajmohan said the proposal was under serious consideration and that the Chief Minister would make the final decision. The reported rationale was student nutrition, welfare, and potentially stronger attendance at government schools.

Source: [newindianexpress.com](https://www.newindianexpress.com) — school meal proposal

This must be described correctly: it is a **proposal**, not a launched scheme. There is no verified final approval, programme order, allocated budget, menu notification, implementation date, or number of students covered in the material reviewed.

Source: [newindianexpress.com](https://www.newindianexpress.com)

Rajmohan has also indicated that the government will pursue dropout-prevention work and reopen low-enrolment schools where at least 10 students are available. The future work implied by this statement includes continuing door-to-door identification of children who have left school, addressing the reasons they dropped out, helping them return, and deciding which schools can be reopened or sustained.

Source: [dinamalar.com](https://www.dinamalar.com)

His stated approach to school governance also points toward future rules controlling visitors and political or non-academic activity in government schools. He said comprehensive guidelines would be issued. Until those guidelines are published, the precise procedures, exceptions, enforcement system, and penalties are not independently verified.

Source: [newindianexpress.com](https://www.newindianexpress.com)

Finally, Rajmohan has said the current school-education allocation will be used efficiently so benefits reach students, teachers, and the education administration. This is a broad budget-management commitment, not a detailed future project list. The **■44,527 crore** figure is the announced allocation cited in reporting; the eventual impact will depend on spending decisions, implementation quality, and publicly available outcome data.

Source: [dinamalar.com](https://www.dinamalar.com)

Website-Ready Paragraph

“Since assuming charge as Tamil Nadu's School Education Minister, Rajmohan Arumugam has focused on foundational learning, government-school readiness, student welfare, fair private-school practices, and technology-enabled education. He released revised activity-based textbooks for Classes 1–3, reaffirmed Tamil Nadu's two-language policy, announced an online system for private-school recognition and NOC approvals, and called for stronger protection of schools as spaces dedicated to learning.”

Source: [thehindu.com](https://www.thehindu.com)

“His current priorities include improving implementation of the revised primary curriculum, supporting enrolment and dropout-prevention efforts, strengthening accountability in private-school fees and approvals, and expanding emerging-technology learning through TN SPARK. Looking ahead, the School Education Department is planning wider digital and coding education, continued school-retention work, and possible student-welfare measures subject to final government approval.”

Source: [dinamalar.com](https://www.dinamalar.com)

Sources Cited in This Document

- Tamil Nadu Government — department profile

Source: https://www.tn.gov.in/dept_profile.php?dep_id

- The Hindu — new activity-rich textbooks

Source:

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/cities/chennai/students-of-classes-i-iii-to-get-activity-rich-colourful-textbooks-when-schools-reopen/article71017847.ece>

- New Indian Express — Classes 1–3 textbooks

Source: <https://www.newindianexpress.com/amp/story/states/tamil-nadu/2026/May/19/tn-minister-rajmohan-releases-new-textbooks-for-classes-1-3>

- Careers360 — school reopening and textbook rollout

Source: <https://news.careers360.com/tamil-nadu-government-launch-9-books-new-curriculum-class-1-3-schools-reopen-june-1-training-amenities-education-minister-rajmohan>

- The News Mill — smart boards at reopening

Source: <https://thenewsmill.com/2026/06/tamil-nadu-education-minister-inaugurates-smart-boards-as-schools-reopen-after-summer-break/>

- The Hindu — two-language policy

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/tamil-nadu/will-remain-committed-to-tamil-nadus-two-language-policy-in-schools-tvk-minister-rajmohan/article70997615.ece>

- Economic Times Education — NEP and NEET position

Source: <https://education.economictimes.indiatimes.com/amp/news/higher-education/tamil-nadus-education-policy-is-sufficient-no-need-for-nep-tn-education-minister-thiru-a-rajmohan/131395122>

- New Indian Express — private-school fee warning

Source:

<https://www.newindianexpress.com/states/tamil-nadu/2026/Jun/05/private-schools-must-stick-to-fee-fixed-by-panel-says-minister-rajmohan-arumugam>

- New Indian Express — online NOC and recognition system

Source: <https://www.newindianexpress.com/states/tamil-nadu/2026/Jun/17/no-more-bribes-private-schools-can-apply-online-for-noc-from-july-1-minister-rajmohan>

- New Indian Express — regulation of visitors to government schools

Source: <https://www.newindianexpress.com/states/tamil-nadu/2026/Jul/10/tn-regulates-visitors-access-to-government-schools-to-issue-norms>

- The Hindu — withdrawal of cases against anti-NEET student protesters

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/tamil-nadu/tamil-nadu-govt-to-withdraw-cases-registered-against-students-during-anti-neet-protests/article71297261.ece>

- Dinamalar Kalvimalar — reopening low-enrolment schools

Source:

<https://www.dinamalar.com/news/kalvimalar-news-en/39ten-students-are-enough39tn-assures-reopening-of-schools-closed-for-low-enrolment/61081>

- Dinamalar Kalvimalar — funding explanation

Source: <https://www.dinamalar.com/news/kalvimalar-news-en/school-education-allocation-not-reduced-says-tn-minister-rajmohan/61010>

- New Indian Express — TN SPARK and AI roadmap

Source: <https://www.newindianexpress.com/states/tamil-nadu/2026/Jul/22/tamil-nadu-charts-ai-roadmap-for-government-school-students>

- New Indian Express — school meal proposal

Source: <https://www.newindianexpress.com/states/tamil-nadu/2026/Aug/01/tn-school-education-minister-defends-weekly-chicken-biryani-proposal-for-government-schools>